HALLOWEEN TRADITIONS

Watch the video "10 Halloween Traditions around the World" by Destination Tips

1 WARM UP: COSTUMES

Task 1: Can you identify the common Halloween costumes below?

Look at the pictures and name each Halloween costume.



1. _____.



2. _____.



3. _____.



4. _____.



5. _____.



6 _____.

Task 2: Discuss the following questions as a class.

1. Which costume would you most like to wear?
2. Which costume is the most popular in your country?
3. Which costume would you never wear? Why?
4. Can you think of any other popular Halloween costumes?



2 HALLOWEEN: VERBS

Task 1: Match a verb to each situation (1-6).

dress up	**carve**	**scare**	**go trick-or-treating**	**decorate**	**celebrate**

1. _____: You cut a face into a pumpkin.
2. _____: You visit your neighbours and ask for sweets.
3. _____: You have a Halloween party with your friends.
4. _____: You put fake spiders on the walls for Halloween.
5. _____: You hide in the dark and surprise someone, shouting “BOO!”
6. _____: You wear a witch costume for a Halloween party.

Task 2: Complete the sentences with the verbs from Task 1. Check the tense.

a. We usually _____ pumpkins before Halloween.

b. Some families _____ in their neighbourhood every year.

c. He jumped out from behind the door to _____ his sister.

d. We usually _____ Halloween by having a party.

e. I’m going to _____ as a vampire this year.

f. We _____ our house with pumpkins and lights.

Task 3: Are the sentences below true or false for you?

1. I enjoy **dressing up** for Halloween. _____.
2. I have **carved** a pumpkin before. _____.
3. I would like to **carve** a pumpkin this Halloween. _____.
4. Horror films **scare** me. _____.
5. I think it's funny when people try to **scare** each other. _____.
6. I **went trick-or-treating** when I was a child. _____.
7. I would feel too old to **go trick-or-treating** now. _____.
8. This Halloween, I will **decorate** my home with lots of decorations. _____.
9. I would rather **celebrate** Halloween at home than go to a party. _____.
10. I would like to **celebrate** Halloween in another country. _____.

3 HALLOWEEN: ADJECTIVES

Task 1: Read the theory about -ed and -ing adjectives.

-ed adjectives
Use -ed adjectives to describe how someone or something feels, or their / its state. • The children were excited about Halloween night.
-ing adjectives
Use -ing to describe the qualities or characteristics of a person, thing, or situation. • The children think Halloween night is exciting.

Task 2: Complete the table by following the pattern of the first example.

1. terrified	**a. terrifying**
2. _____.	**b. frightening**
3. _____.	**c. haunting**
4. excited	**d. _____.**
5. surprised	**e. _____.**
6. tired	**f. _____.**
7. _____.	**g. disappointing**
8. embarrassed.	**h. _____**
9. _____.	**i. confusing**
10. _____	**j. amusing.**

Task 3: Choose the correct adjective to complete the sentence.

1. The haunted house was **frightened / frightening.**
2. I felt **terrified / terrifying** when I heard the noise.
3. The children were **excited / exciting** about the Halloween party.
4. The ghost story was really **confused / confusing**.
5. We were **surprised / surprising** by the news.
6. The Halloween film was **disappointed / disappointing.**
7. I was **embarrassed / embarrassing** when I forgot my costume.
8. The old house looked **haunted / haunting**.

Task 4: Complete the sentences with the correct form of the adjective in brackets.

a. I was _____ when I saw the ghost. (**terrify**)

b. The haunted house was really _____. (**frighten**)

c. We were _____ about the Halloween party. (**excite**)

d. I would feel _____ if everyone laughed at my costume. (**embarrass**)

e. I was _____ by the strange noise. (**surprise**)

f. The horror film was so _____ that I couldn't sleep. (**terrify**)

g. The instructions for the Halloween game were _____. (**confuse**)

h. Decorating the whole house for Halloween can be _____. (**tire**)

Task 5: Choose an adjective from Task 1 to describe how you would feel. Explain.

1. You have to spend the night alone in a haunted house.
2. Your friends organise a surprise Halloween party for you.
3. You arrive at a school Halloween party wearing the same costume as your teacher.
4. You hear a strange noise downstairs at midnight.
5. Someone tells you a very funny Halloween joke.
6. You stay awake all night watching horror films.
7. Someone tells you that Halloween is celebrated differently in ten countries.
8. You win a Halloween competition that you didn't expect to win.

4 VIDEO: KEY WORDS

Task 1: Match a word from the video, in the box below, to the situations (1-8).

graveyard	**spirits**	**tradition**	**deceased**
offerings	**bonfire**	**ancestors**	**fortune-telling**

1. You visit a place where dead people are buried. → _____.
2. You leave food or other things for dead people or spirits. → _____.
3. You light a large outdoor fire. → _____.
4. You believe invisible beings of dead people are nearby. → _____.
5. Your family members from the distant past. → _____.
6. Something that people have done for many years. → _____.
7. You try to discover what will happen in the future. → _____.
8. Another word for "dead". → _____.

Task 2: Read and discuss the situations as a class.

a. You hear strange noises coming from a **graveyard** at night. What would you do?
b. Your friend says they can talk to **spirits**. Would you believe them?
c. You can start a new Halloween **tradition** in your family. What would it be?
d. You find a letter written by a **deceased** family member. Would you read it?
e. You are asked to leave **offerings** for the dead. What would you leave?
f. You are invited to a huge **bonfire** on Halloween night. Would you go?
g. You can meet one of your **ancestors** from 200 years ago. What would you ask them?
h. A stranger offers you **fortune-telling** for free. Would you try it?

Task 3: Practice using the key words by answering the following questions.

1. Would you rather spend a night in a **graveyard** or spend a night in a haunted house?
2. Would you rather see a **spirit** or hear a **spirit**?
3. Would you rather take part in an old **tradition** or create a new one?
4. Would you rather learn about your ancestors or your future through **fortune-telling**?
5. Would you rather build your own **bonfire** or go to a public **bonfire**?
6. Would you rather make **offerings** for your **ancestors** or visit their graves?

5 VIDEO: HALLOWEEN TRADITIONS

Task 1: Read the video-based statements and decide if they are true or false.

Compare and discuss each of your answers with a classmate.

1. _____: Halloween dates back hundreds of years to Celtic cultures.
2. _____: The Day of the Dead takes place around the same time as Christmas.
3. _____: The tiger is an important symbol of the Day of the Dead.
4. _____: The Festival of Hungry Ghosts takes place in August.
5. _____: The Festival of Hungry Ghosts has Buddhist origins.
6. _____: All Saints celebrations in Germany last for more than a week.
7. _____: Pumpkins are native to Europe.
8. _____: Halloween became popular in Sweden during the 1990s.
9. _____: Guy Fawkes Night takes place on December 5.
10. _____: The Odo Festival takes place every two years.

Task 2: Say which country or countries the statements are connected to.

a. Which country leaves bread and water out for the souls of the dead?

b. Which country has a tradition of placing chairs around a bonfire for the deceased?

c. Which country celebrates the Day of the Dead?

d. Which country has the Festival of Hungry Ghosts?

e. Which country has a tradition of hiding kitchen knives?

f. Which two countries have a long tradition of lighting bonfires around Halloween?

g. Which country traditionally carved turnips instead of pumpkins?

h. Which country has a Halloween tradition involving barmbrack?

i. Which country celebrates Alla Helgons Dag?

j. Which country celebrates the Odo Festival?



6 DISCUSSION: HALLOWEEN

Task 1: Discuss the video and topic by answering the following questions.

1. **Which Halloween tradition from the video did you find the most interesting or surprising? Why?**
2. **How is Halloween usually celebrated in your country? What do you normally do with your friends and family?**
3. **Is Halloween becoming more popular in your country? Why do you think this is happening?**
4. **What was Halloween like for you when you were a child? Did you dress up, go trick-or-treating or do anything else?**
5. **How important is Halloween in your country compared with other holidays or festivals?**
6. **How important is alcohol to the tourism industry in cities that are famous for their nightlife?**
7. **Why do you think Halloween traditions are so different from country to country? Which traditions from other countries would you like to try?**
8. **How do films, TV shows and social media influence the way people celebrate Halloween?**
9. **Do you think Halloween is mainly a fun celebration, a commercial event, or an important cultural tradition? Why?**
10. **Why do you think people enjoy being scared? What makes horror and Halloween so popular?**

7 DEBATE: HALLOWEEN

Task 1: Decide if you agree or disagree with each person, and explain why.

John



"I think Halloween should be celebrated in every country because it gives people a chance to have fun and spend time together. It is not important where the tradition originally came from."

Kate



"I think the popularity of Halloween is mainly because of American films and television. Without American pop culture, Halloween would not be nearly as popular around the world."

Liam



"I think Halloween has become too commercial. Companies make people feel that they need to spend a lot of money on costumes, decorations and sweets, so Halloween is more about shopping than having fun."

Jack



"I think Halloween is a good thing for local businesses. Shops, restaurants and entertainment venues can earn extra money, while customers get new ways to enjoy the holiday."

Express an opinion	**Express disagreement**
It seems to me that... I feel that... I'm absolutely convinced that... In my opinion,... I believe / suppose / feel (that)...	I don't agree with you about... I can't accept your view that... I have a different opinion... I'm not sure if... I'm not convinced that...
Express pros and cons	**Summarise**
There are two sides to this point... On the one hand...,on the other hand... An argument for / against is... Some people think that...,others say that... The advantages / disadvantages are...	So, in conclusion... To summarise.. Overall, it is clear that... As a result.. The bottom line is...

8 HALLOWEEN: CASE STUDIES

Task 1: Read each case study (1-4) then answer the questions.

Compare and discuss each of your answers with a classmate.

1. **Halloween In School.** A school in Spain has decided to organise its first Halloween celebration. Many students are excited because they love American Halloween films and want to wear costumes, play games and decorate the school. However, some parents think Halloween is not part of Spanish culture and would prefer the school to celebrate a traditional Spanish festival instead.

    a. Why are the students excited about the Halloween celebration?
    b. Why do some parents disagree with the school's decision?
    c. What do you think the school should do? Why?

2. **Halloween In Business.** A small town in the UK has traditionally held a local autumn festival. A large company now wants to organise a huge Halloween event in the town centre. It would include a haunted house, food stalls, music, costumes and activities for children. The company says the event would attract thousands of visitors and bring money to local businesses. However, some residents are worried that the traditional festival will become less important.

    a. Why does the company want to organise a Halloween event?
    b. Why are some local people worried about the event?
    c. What do you think the town should do? Why?

3. **Expensive Costume.** Leo is 14 and wants to buy a $220 Halloween costume. He has seen the costume on social media and says that lots of his friends will be wearing it. His parents think £120 is far too much for something he will probably wear once. Leo says Halloween only happens once a year and he wants to look good in photos with his friends.

    a. Why does Leo want to buy the expensive costume?
    b. How much would you spend on a Halloween costume?
    c. What do you think Leo should do? Why?

4. **Halloween Prank.** Three teenagers make a Halloween video for social media. They dress as frightening characters and secretly scare people in a shopping centre. The video became very popular and got thousands of views. However, one person in the video becomes extremely frightened and complains to the shopping centre. The teenagers say it was only a joke and nobody was seriously hurt.

    a. Why did the teenagers make the video?
    b. Was the prank harmless, or did the teenagers go too far? Why?
    c. What do you think the teenagers should do now?

9 HALLOWEEN: PICTURES

Task 1: Study the pictures below, then give each one a title.





1. _____. **2.** _____.





3. _____. **4.** _____.

Task 2: Discuss the images as a class using the questions below.

a. What do you think the people are doing?

b. How do you think the people feel? Why?

c. What do you think happened before each picture was taken?

d. What do you think will happen next?

e. Which picture looks the most traditional? Why?

f. Would you enjoy doing these activities? Why or why not?

g. Which picture is most similar to Halloween in your country?



HOMEWORK

1 ARTICLE: WHY IS HALLOWEEN SO POPULAR?

Task 1: Read the article that explores why it has become so popular around the world.

Every Halloween, millions of people dress up, decorate their homes, watch scary films and enjoy parties. Although Halloween has its roots in ancient traditions, it is now celebrated in many countries. But why has this festival become so popular?

One reason is that Halloween is fun. People can dress up as almost anyone or anything they want. Children might become witches, vampires or superheroes, while adults can enjoy creating funny or frightening costumes. Halloween also gives people a chance to be creative by making decorations, carving pumpkins and preparing special food.

Another reason for Halloween's popularity is the excitement of being scared. Many people enjoy watching horror films, visiting haunted houses or telling scary stories. Halloween allows people to experience fear in a safe and enjoyable way. For children, activities such as trick-or-treating can also make the evening feel like a special adventure.

Films, television and social media have also helped Halloween become popular around the world. American films and TV shows often show Halloween parties, costumes and trick-or-treating. People in other countries have seen these celebrations and started to introduce some of the traditions themselves. Social media has made this even easier, as people can share their costumes, decorations and Halloween parties with others.

Halloween is also a good opportunity for businesses to make money. Shops sell costumes, decorations, sweets and pumpkins, while restaurants and entertainment venues organise special events. This has made Halloween an important commercial event in many countries.

However, Halloween is not celebrated in the same way everywhere. Some countries have their own traditions for remembering the dead, while others have created new Halloween traditions. This mixture of old and new has helped Halloween become a global celebration.

Task 2: Write detailed answers to the following questions.

1. Why has Halloween become popular in many countries?
2. How does Halloween give people a chance to be creative?
3. Why do some people enjoy being scared at Halloween?
4. How have films, TV and social media helped spread Halloween?
5. How does Halloween help businesses make money?

